- Hold the wrist firmly, place first three fingers over the artery, and press it to make the pulsation distinct.
- Count the pulse for one minute.
- Note rhythm, volume and any other abnormalities.
- Record your observation.



Palpation of Pulse

Common Abnormalities in Pulse Rate	
Rate	Number of beats per minutes
Tachycardia	Pulse rate too high
Bradycardia	Pulse rate too low
Rhythm	Regularity of pulse
Arrhythmias	Irregular or abnormal rhythm
Volume	Strength or intensity of pulse
Abnormal	Thready pulse, weak, strong and bounding

6.6.3 Respiration

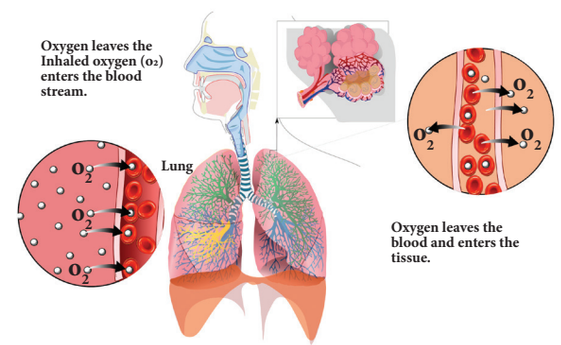
It is defined as the movement of oxygen from the outside environment to the cells within tissues, and the transport of carbon dioxide in the opposite direction.

Respiration involves: ventilation, diffusion and Perfusion

- **Ventilation** the movement of gases in and out of the lungs. The rate, depth and rhythm of ventilator movements indicate the quality and efficiency of ventilation.
- **Diffusion** is the movement of oxygen and CO_2 between the alveoli and the red blood cells.
- **Perfusion** is the distribution of red blood cells to and from the pulmonary capillaries.

DO YOU KNOW?

The average time an adult can hold her or his breath is between 30 to 60 seconds.



DO YOU KNOW?

The lungs are the only organ that can float on water.

Physiology of Respiration

The rate and depth of breathing can change in response to body demands. These changes are brought about by the the inhibition or stimulation of the respiratory muscles by respiratory centers in the medulla and pons.

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